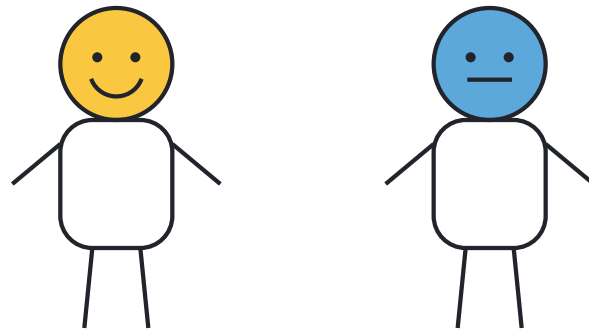


LITTLE FEELINGS SOCIAL STORIES



# Making Friends and Joining a Group

A Social Story With Conversation Cards

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

**Ages 5-9 - Social story + conversation cards**

**A read-aloud social story with activities**

Home - Classroom - Counseling

## How to Share This Book

Social stories gently walk a child through a situation and model calm, kind choices. Read this book together, more than once. The repetition is what helps - it lets a child rehearse the feelings and choices before the real moment happens.

This book helps a child understand the feeling, see that it is normal, and practice calm, kind choices - before the real moment happens.

### How to use it

- ☐ Read the story slowly and out loud, pointing at the pictures.
- ☐ Read it again on calm days - not only in the hard moment.
- ☐ Pause to let your child color, answer, or act out the pages.
- ☐ Praise effort and calm tries, not perfection.
- ☐ Use the calm-down tools together so they feel familiar later.

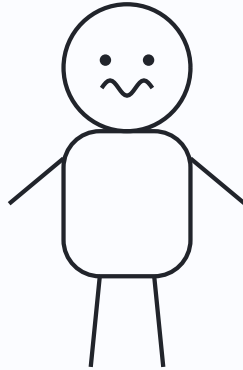
# What's Inside

- 1 The Story: Joining In
- 2 Friendly Faces
- 3 Conversation Cards
- 4 Friendly Words
- 5 What Would You Do?
- 6 My Friendship Plan
- 7 My Certificate



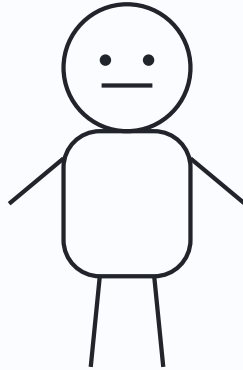
# The Story

How to Join In



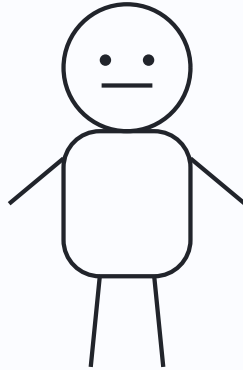
Sometimes I see other kids playing.

I want to join, but I feel nervous. What if they say no?



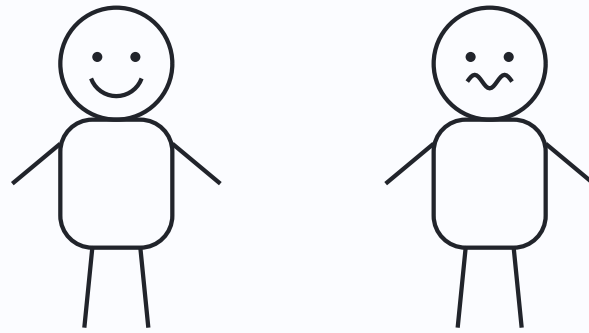
Feeling nervous about joining in is normal.

Lots of kids feel exactly the same way.



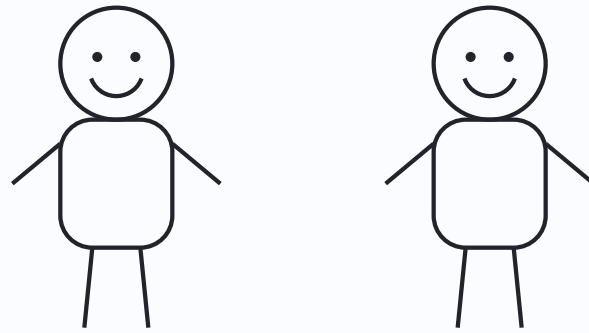
First, I watch for a moment to see what they are playing.

Then I walk over with a friendly face and a smile.



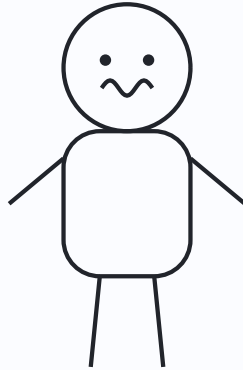
I can say a friendly hello.

'Hi! Can I play too?' or 'That looks fun - what are you playing?'



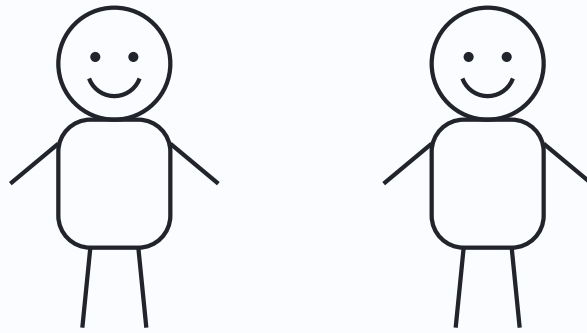
Sometimes they say yes right away.

I join in, take turns, and follow the game they are already playing.



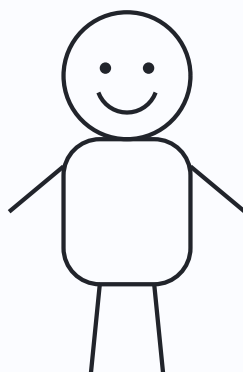
Sometimes they say 'not right now.'

That feels disappointing, but it is not about me. I can try again or find someone else.



Being a good friend means listening, sharing, and being kind.

Friends are made a little at a time.



Every time I practice, joining in gets easier.

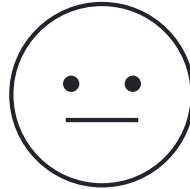
I can be brave and friendly. I can make friends!

# Friendly Feelings

Color each face. Say the feeling out loud.



Nervous



Brave



Friendly



Left Out



Excited



Included

## Conversation Starter Cards

Cut out and practice these friendly things to say.

**1 Say hello**

'Hi, I'm \_\_\_\_\_. What's your name?'

**2 Ask to join**

'That looks fun. Can I play too?'

**3 Give a compliment**

'I really like your drawing!'

**4 Ask a question**

'What are you playing?'

**5 Offer to share**

'Do you want to use this with me?'

**6 Invite them**

'Want to play together?'

## Friendly Words to Trace

Trace the words. Then say them out loud.

Can I play too?

---

Hi, my name is...

---

Want to play?

---

## What Would You Do?

Read each situation together. There are many good choices! Talk it through, then write or draw what you could do.

- 1 A group is playing a game you'd like to join.**

*What could you do?*

---

---

- 2 You said hi but the kid seemed shy and didn't answer.**

*What could you do?*

---

---

- 3 You feel left out at recess.**

*What could you do?*

---

---

## My Friendship Plan

- A friendly thing I can say to join in is...

---

---

---

- If someone says 'not now,' I can...

---

---

---

- One way I can be a good friend is...

---

---

---

## My Calm-Down Toolkit

Out of all the tools in this book, which ones help YOU most? Draw or write your top tools here so you remember them when a big feeling comes.

1

---

2

---

3

---

4

---

5

---

## What I Learned

- The most helpful thing I learned was...

---

---

---

- One thing I will try next time is...

---

---

---

## My Feelings Journal

● A time I felt this feeling was...

---

---

---

● What helped me feel better was...

---

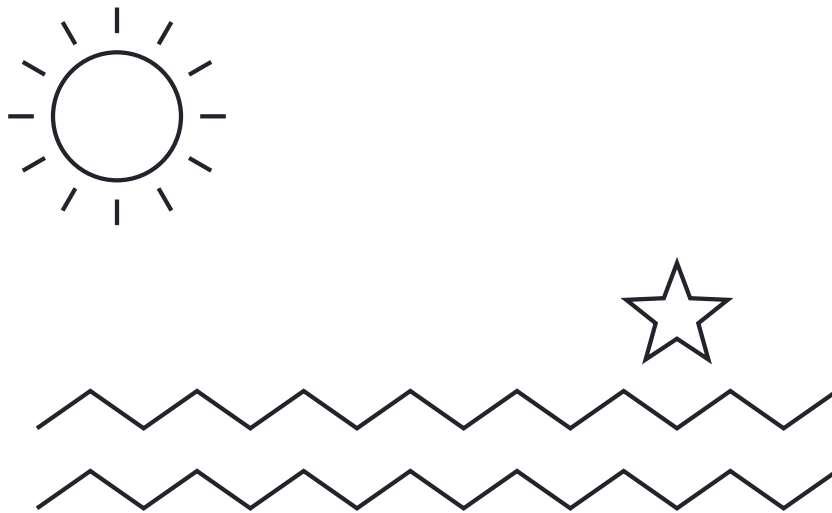
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COLOR

## My Calm Place

Draw and color a place where you feel calm and safe.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

WORDS

## Calm Words to Trace

Trace the words. Then say them out loud.

I am safe.

---

I can ask for help.

---

This will pass.

---

## People Who Help Me

● Who are my safe grown-ups?

---

---

---

● How can they help me?

---

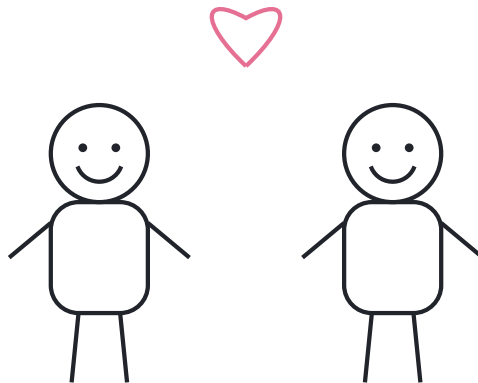
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# Happy Together

Color two friends being kind to each other.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

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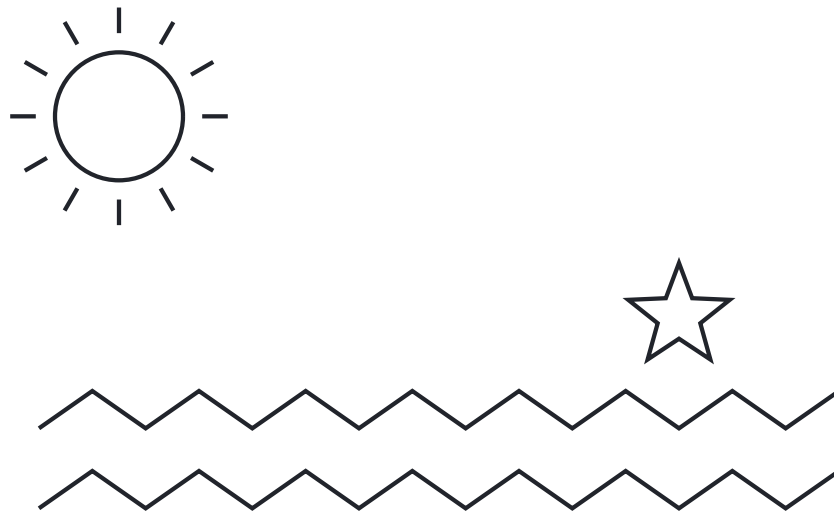
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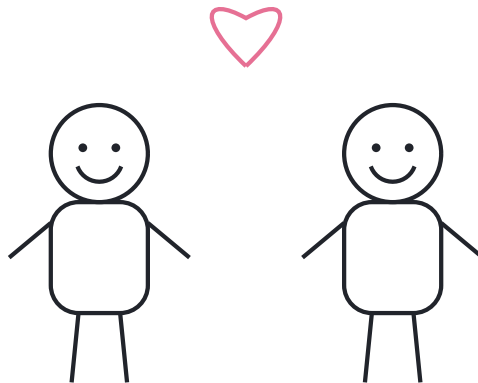
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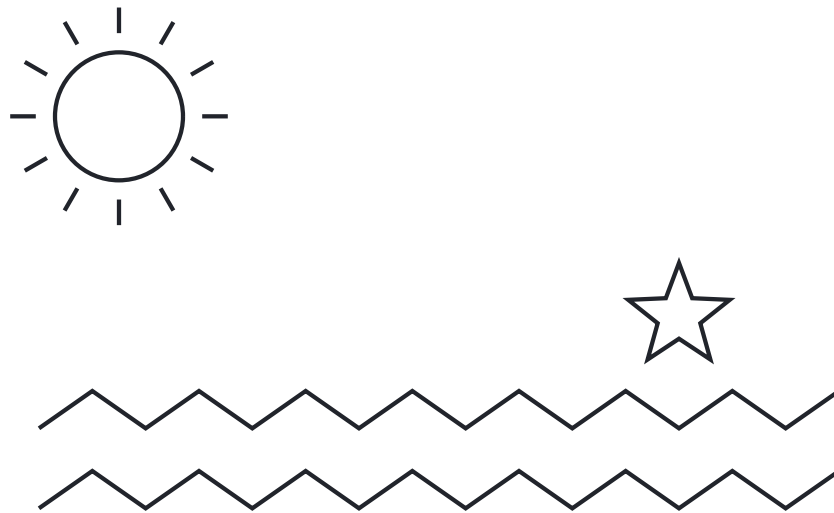
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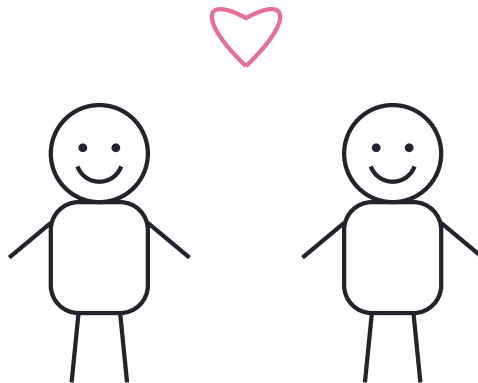
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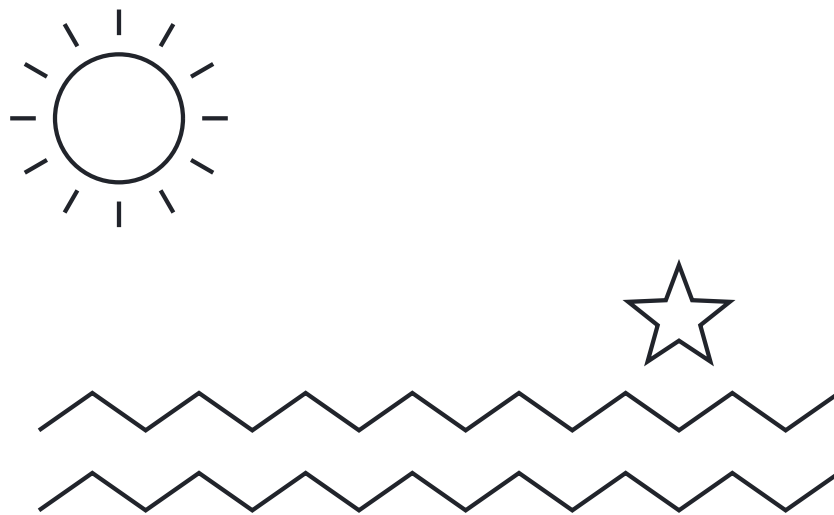
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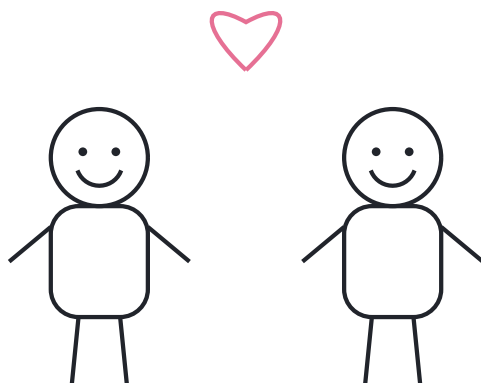
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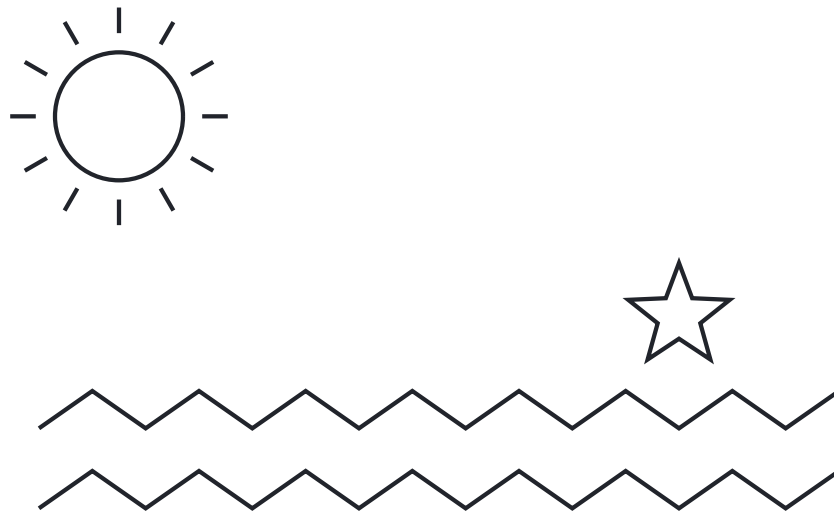
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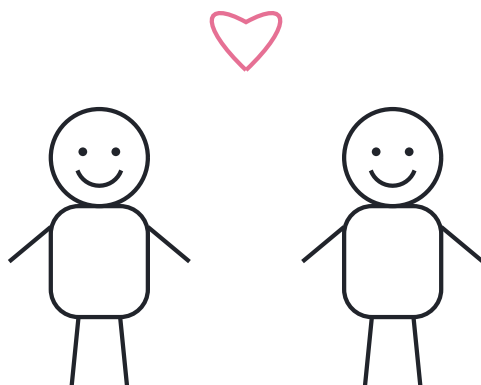
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# CERTIFICATE

This certificate is proudly given to

---

(write your name)

for being brave and friendly when making friends!

---

Grown-up

---

Date